EHSAAS 2026 — IMPACT REPORT

A 45-Day Children-Led Kindness Movement

A Note on Ehsaas

There are things we own that we rarely question.

Objects that quietly become a part of our everyday lives, books we have outgrown, clothes we no longer wear, toys that slowly lose their place. Over time, they stop holding our attention, even though they still hold value.

What we often overlook is that this experience is not universal.

For many children, access to these very things is limited, not occasionally, but consistently. The gap is not always visible, but it exists in everyday ways.

Ehsaas began with this awareness.

Not as a structured program or a defined initiative, but as an attempt to create moments where children could experience something simple yet powerful, the act of giving, not out of obligation, but out of understanding.

Over the course of 45 days, Ehsaas brought together children, families, and communities across Mumbai through a series of interactions designed to encourage reflection and participation.

What emerged was not just a collection of activities, but a shift in perspective, in how children viewed what they had, and what it meant to share it.

Overview of the Movement

Ehsaas 2026 was conducted as a 45-day initiative, bringing together children, families, community spaces, and partner organisations across Mumbai.

Key highlights of the movement include:

- 9 Kindness Box locations across the city
- Over 340 items collected through community donations
- 300 hampers created and distributed
- 300 children from Hunar Sikho NGO reached
- 41 children engaged through a Classical Dance workshop
- 20 children participated in a kindness-focused workshop

These numbers reflect participation, but the impact of Ehsaas extended beyond them, into behaviour, awareness, and perspective.

Kindness Box Donation Drive

The Kindness Box Donation Drive served as the foundation of the Ehsaas initiative. It was launched on 1st February 2026 with the aim of making giving simple and accessible.

The drive began with five locations across Mumbai:

- Nandan Coffee, Fort
- Anna Idli, Fort
- Oroma Café, Kemps Corner
- Bombay to Barcelona Library & Café, Marol
- Magari Café, Kandivali West

As participation increased, four additional locations joined the initiative:

- Greenr Café, Breach Candy
- Brownie Cottage, Bandra
- Brownie Cottage, Belapur
- The Little House, Versova

Over the course of the drive, these locations became consistent points of engagement where individuals and families contributed items for children. Donations included educational materials, toys, clothing, school supplies, and creative kits.

A total of 340+ items were collected, including:

- Books, notebooks, and writing materials
- Art supplies such as colour sets and drawing books
- Toys and soft toys
- School bags and stationery
- Clothing for children across age groups

While the volume of items collected was significant, what stood out more was the nature of participation. Many contributors chose to donate items that held personal value, indicating a shift from transactional giving to thoughtful sharing.

Kindness Workshop

On 12th February 2026, a kindness workshop was conducted at Genius Learning Centre, Fort, with the objective of introducing children to the idea of empathy.

The session focused on helping participants understand what it means to give and why it matters. However, the most meaningful outcome came after the workshop.

Approximately 20 children returned with items that were personally meaningful to them and chose to donate them at the Kindness Box locations. This response demonstrated a clear internalisation of the concept, where giving was not prompted but self-initiated.

The workshop reinforced the idea that children, when given the right context, are capable of understanding and acting on empathy in a genuine way.

Community Recognition

On 13th February 2026, Ehsaas was featured in *Mid-Day* under the title *"Open Hearts, Open Hands."*

This recognition reflected the growing visibility of the initiative and highlighted the relevance of its approach within the wider community. It also helped extend the reach of Ehsaas beyond immediate participants.

Kathak Kala Shibir

As part of the experiential component of Ehsaas, a Kathak workshop was conducted on 21st February 2026 in collaboration with Smt. Guru Shruti Nandoskar, Founder and Director of Nrityashree Kathak Vidyalaya. Our Co-Founder, Urvashii Thosar, who is also a student of Nandoskar, assisted her in conducting this workshop

The workshop engaged 41 children associated with Prerana NGO and introduced them to classical dance as a form of expression.

The session focused on:

- Basic movement and rhythm
- Storytelling through dance
- Building confidence and discipline

For many participants, this was their first exposure to a structured art form. The workshop created an environment where children could engage with culture, express themselves, and participate in a shared learning experience.

Hamper Distribution Day

The final phase of the initiative took place on 14th March 2026 and brought together the efforts of the entire movement.

A total of 300 hampers were prepared by volunteers, team members of Ehsaas. The hamper packing was supported by the experiential event space, Nautilus, Bandra (west). These hampers were then transported to Shahu Nagar Playground in Mahim (east) and distributed to 300 children from Hunar Sikho NGO.

The hampers included contributions from multiple partners:

- Dot Line Space Art Foundation (Bal Kala Shibir) provided 300 Art on Wheels kits by DOMS
- Urban Platter contributed 300 units of Jowar Puffs
- Skillmatics provided a mix of 100 products, including Waxy Window Art, Craftopedia, and Tangram Twist

The distribution process was designed to be more than a logistical activity. It created an opportunity for children from different backgrounds to interact in a shared space.

The focus was not only on the act of giving, but on ensuring that the experience was respectful, inclusive, and meaningful for all participants.

A total of ₹5,229 was collected through direct fund donations as part of the Ehsaas 2026 initiative. In line with the intent of supporting organisations working closely with children, this amount will be equally distributed between Street Angel Foundation and Hunar Sikho NGO, with 50% allocated to each. While modest in scale, this contribution represents the collective effort of individuals who chose to participate in the movement, reinforcing the idea that even small acts of giving, when brought together, can contribute meaningfully to a larger purpose.

Key Learnings and Impact

Ehsaas 2026 offered a clear insight into how children and communities respond when empathy is experienced rather than instructed.

A few patterns became evident:

Children do not need to be convinced to be kind. When given the opportunity and context, they respond with sincerity and without hesitation. In many cases, their willingness to give exceeded expectations, not in quantity, but in intention.

The act of giving becomes significantly more meaningful when it involves choice. When children selected items that mattered to them, the process shifted from donation to conscious sharing. This distinction shaped the quality of participation throughout the initiative.

Accessibility plays a critical role in participation. By placing Kindness Boxes in familiar, everyday spaces, the barrier to entry was reduced, allowing more individuals and families to engage naturally with the initiative.

Experiences created deeper impact than transactions. Workshops, shared activities, and direct interactions allowed children to understand empathy in a lived context, rather than as an abstract idea.

Finally, the initiative highlighted that awareness often extends beyond the child. In many instances, parents and families paused to reflect on consumption, privilege, and the value of what they already had.

Ehsaas did not attempt to teach empathy in isolation. Instead, it created conditions where empathy could be experienced and that made all the difference.

Partners and Collaborators

Ehsaas 2026 was made possible through the support of community spaces, partner organisations, and contributors.

NGO Partners:

- Hunar Sikho NGO
- Prerana NGO
- Street Angel Foundation

Community & Venue Partners:

- Nandan Coffee, Fort
- Anna Idli, Fort
- Oroma Café, Kemps Corner
- Bombay to Barcelona Library & Café, Marol
- Magari Café, Kandivali
- Greenr Café, Breach Candy
- Brownie Cottage (Bandra & Belapur)
- The Little House, Versova

Hamper Contributors:

- Dot Line Space Art Foundation
- Urban Platter
- Skillmatics

Supporting Partner for Hamper Distribution Day

- Nautilis

Cultural Experience Partner:

- Nrityashree Kathak Vidyalaya

Looking Ahead

Ehsaas 2026 established a strong foundation for future iterations of the initiative.

Building on the learnings from this year, the next phase will focus on expanding the scale and depth of engagement through:

- Increased number of Kindness Box locations
- Structured life skills programs
- Wider school participation
- Larger community involvement

The aim is to continue creating spaces where children can learn, experience, and practice empathy in a consistent and meaningful way.

Conclusion

At some point while reading this, you may have found yourself thinking about something you own. Something you no longer use. Or something you still value, but could choose to share.

That moment of thought is important.

Because it is in that moment, when awareness turns into a quiet question, that change begins.

Ehsaas was built on many such moments. Moments where people paused, reconsidered, and chose to act differently. The impact of the initiative is not limited to what was collected or distributed. It lies in the shift it created, in how children experienced giving, and how communities engaged with the idea of sharing.

As Ehsaas moves forward, its purpose remains the same: to continue creating these moments, at a larger scale, and with deeper intention. Because empathy is not a one-time action.
It is something that grows each time it is felt, understood, and acted upon.